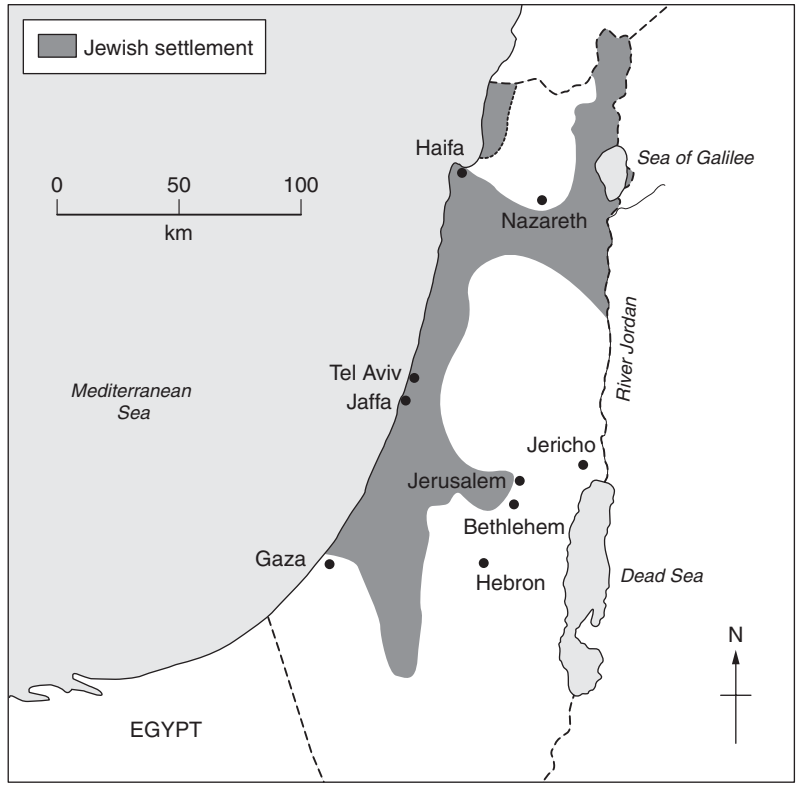
'state' so as not to be accused of trying to make the Jewish minority become the masters of the Arab majority. He knew there was a limit to how far he could push the British. As a leading British Zionist, he knew that if the Jewish national home was to survive it needed the continued support of the British rulers of Palestine.

Arab–Jewish riots

Ever since the first Jewish settlers had arrived in Palestine from Russia in 1882, there had been attacks on Jewish property and people. In 1921 violence on a massive scale erupted in the town of Jaffa (see the map below), a busy sea port. Jaffa was different from other Arab coastal towns because it was the main port of arrival for Jewish immigrants. Just to the north of the town was Tel Aviv, the largest Jewish settlement in Palestine. In 1921 riots erupted in Tel Aviv between rival Jewish groups. The fighting spread into Arab Jaffa and led to Arab attacks on Jews and their property. After two days of rioting, 200 Jews and 120 Arabs were dead or wounded.

The British authorities immediately stopped all Jewish immigration and the Palestinian Arabs were told that only a part of Palestine was to be made into a Jewish national home. Soon afterwards immigration began again but the British insisted it would be limited. The Arabs asked the British government to make Palestine independent as they hoped that the Arab majority



The main areas of Jewish settlement in Palestine in the 1920s.